



LiveKit Bay Area developer community: a 90- day events and content plan

LiveKit

PREPARED FOR THE STAFF DEVELOPER ADVOCATE,
COMMUNITY & EVENTS SEARCH

About me

Developer advocate whose home turf is real-time media, and who builds the demo before booking the room.

I architected a streaming backend that held 50,000+ concurrent users for DirecTV LATAM, AT&T and IBM, wrote Kino, a 7-crate Rust HLS/DASH player, and built a GPU/NVENC encode pipeline (16x encode, VMAF 95.8). Real-time audio and video is the part of the stack I know from the inside.

As Developer Relations Engineer at ZetaChain I took the developer base to 10,000+ active developers by owning the docs, SDKs, starter kits and the Discord and Telegram channels, and by turning recurring questions into guides and roadmap items. I have spoken at EthCC 2025, ETH NYC and ETH Denver, won four hackathons as a competitor, published three technical books, and shipped 15+ production MCP servers. Claude Certified Architect (Anthropic, 2026). B.F.A., Point Park University.

Our Mission:

Fill the room with developers who leave having built something, then carry what they said back to the people who build the product.

Why Matthew Karsten?

- Real-time media is not a topic I learned for the interview: 50,000+ concurrent-user OTT delivery, a Rust HLS/DASH player, GStreamer and NVENC pipelines.
- I have already built for LiveKit: livekit-ops-mcp, 24 tools, integration-tested against a live server, with a hackathon kit that spins up rooms and tokens in one call.
- Events I run produce artifacts: every meetup ends with a recap, a demo video and a repo, so the reach outlasts the room.
- Hackathons from both sides: four wins as a competitor, so I know what a bad kit feels like at 2 a.m. and what a good one lets a team ship.
- Feedback becomes issues, not anecdotes: field notes to Product every week with quotes, repro steps and counts.
- Public track record: 139 public repositories, packages on npm and the MCP Registry, three published books, three conference stages.

Re: Staff Developer Advocate, Community & Events

The posting says the role is a hybrid of content creation and event execution, that the Bay Area is where LiveKit has the most room to grow, and that the advocate should bring developer signal back to Product. This is what I would do about each of those in the first 90 days, with dates, targets, and tooling I have already built so the hackathon is repeatable.

Where I did not know something (venue budget, start date, who takes the AMA) I made an assumption and wrote it down so it can be corrected in week one.

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Three San Francisco meetups, one hands-on workshop, one Saturday voice-agent hackathon for 100 builders, two conference talk submissions with verified open CFPs, a recap-demo-tutorial content engine behind every event, and a weekly field-notes feedback loop from the community to Product, measured against the targets on the last page.

What I would deliver by day 90

Prepared for:

LiveKit,

Prepared for the LiveKit DevRel and Marketing team. By the end of the first 90 days the following exist and are measured:

- (a) Five Bay Area events, hosted end to end (venue, speakers, run of show, follow-up):
 - Meetup #1: Voice agents in production (Oct 21)
 - Workshop: Your first voice agent in 60 minutes (Oct 28)
 - Meetup #2: Telephony and SIP, Summit week (Nov 11)
 - Bay Area Voice Agent Hackathon, 100 builders (Nov 21)
 - Meetup #3: Hackathon winners and roadmap AMA (Dec 9)
 - Q1 2027 calendar published by day 90
- (b) Two conference talk submissions to CFPs verified open on Sept 14, 2026: AI Engineer Code Summit (San Francisco, Nov 10 to 12; CFP closes Oct 11, 2026) and ScaLE 24x (Pasadena, Apr 1 to 4, 2027; CFP closes Nov 1, 2026).
- (c) Content within 72 hours of every event: five recaps, six or more captioned demo videos, four tutorials (one per workshop track, three rebuilt from winning hackathon projects), each backed by a public repo.
- (d) The feedback loop on a schedule: twelve weekly field-notes documents to Product, DevRel and PMM; ten or more GitHub issues with reproduction steps; three monthly signal reviews; one day-90 community report.
- (e) The hackathon kit, already built and tested, released as LiveKit's reference template for community-run hackathons: livekit-ops-mcp, 24 MCP tools over the LiveKit server API including workshop_spinup, workshop_join_sheet, workshop_status, workshop_broadcast and workshop_teardown.

What the built project already proves: on Sept 14, 2026, against a real livekit-server 1.13.7, one MCP call created two team rooms with seat and mentor tokens; a real WebRTC participant joined with a minted token, was listed, renamed and received a server-sent data message; the join sheet rendered; teardown left zero rooms. 17 steps, 0 failures.

Not in this plan: paid advertising, a LiveKit-run conference, or travel beyond the two submitted talks. Those are month-4 conversations once the first three months have numbers.

Scope:

github.com/ExpertVagabond/livekit-ops-mcp: MIT, TypeScript, 24 tools, unit tests + live-server smoke test

github.com/ExpertVagabond: 139 public repositories, 15+ production MCP servers

The 90-day event calendar

Assumes a Monday, October 5, 2026 start. Dates shift with the start date; the two CFP deadlines do not.

Three monthly San Francisco meetups, one hands-on workshop, one Saturday hackathon, two conference submissions. Every event is sized to what a single advocate can run well with one Marketing partner, and every event feeds the content engine on the next page.

Month 1 (Oct 5 to Nov 1): listen, then host

- Weeks 1 to 2: attend three existing Bay Area AI and voice meetups as a participant, audit LiveKit's community channels, and interview ten developers who built on LiveKit in the last quarter.
- By Oct 11: submit a talk to **AI Engineer Code Summit** (San Francisco, Nov 10 to 12; CFP closes Oct 11, 2026). Proposed title: "Operating voice agents at 2 a.m.: what a hackathon room teaches you about production."
- Week 3 (Oct 21): **SF LiveKit Meetup #1, "Voice agents in production"**. Two 20-minute talks (one LiveKit customer, one internal engineer), open-mic demos, 60 to 80 developers.
- Week 4 (Oct 28): **Workshop, "Your first voice agent in 60 minutes"**. 30 seats, laptops open, rooms and tokens provisioned with livekit-ops-mcp so nobody spends the hour on setup.
- By Nov 1: submit a talk to **SCaLE 24x** (Pasadena, Apr 1 to 4, 2027; CFP closes Nov 1, 2026). Proposed title: "An open-source WebRTC stack you can run at a hackathon: rooms, tokens and egress with LiveKit."

Month 2 (Nov 2 to Nov 29): the hackathon

- Week 6 (Nov 11): **SF LiveKit Meetup #2** as an AI Engineer Code Summit side event (the week the Bay Area's agent builders are already in town). Theme: telephony and SIP, with a live phone-number demo.
- Week 7 (Nov 21): **Bay Area Voice Agent Hackathon**, Saturday, 9 a.m. to 9 p.m. Target 100 builders in 25 teams. `workshop_spinup` creates 25 rooms and 100 seat tokens before doors open; `workshop_join_sheet` prints the QR strips; `workshop_status` tells mentors which teams are stuck; `workshop_broadcast` runs the clock.
- Judging: working demo over a real call, not slides. Prizes tied to LiveKit Cloud credits and a slot at Meetup #3.

Month 3 (Nov 30 to Jan 2): showcase and report

- Week 9 (Dec 9): **SF LiveKit Meetup #3, "Hackathon winners + roadmap AMA"**. The three winning teams present; a LiveKit product lead takes questions collected at the previous events.
- Weeks 10 to 12: content and reporting push (holiday weeks are low for events, high for reading). Publish the winners' tutorials, the day-90 community report, and the Q1 2027 calendar with the two accepted or pending talks.

The content engine

Every event produces three artifacts within 72 hours: a recap, a demo, a tutorial

Events reach the people in the room. Content reaches everyone who could not make it and everyone who searches for the topic six months later. The rule is that nothing is presented that has not already been written down as a runnable repo, so the recap, the demo video and the tutorial are cuts of the same material, not three separate projects.

Per event

- Recap post on the LiveKit blog within 72 hours: what was shown, what people asked, with photos and links to the repos.
- One 2 to 4 minute demo video per talk, captioned, cut for X, LinkedIn and YouTube with Marketing.
- One written tutorial per workshop or hackathon track, starting from a repo with tests, ending in something the reader can run against LiveKit Cloud.
- A social thread the same day, drafted by me, scheduled with Marketing.

From the hackathon

- Winners' showcase post and three tutorials rebuilt from the winning projects, each published as an open-source starter repo.
- A "what 25 teams built in 12 hours" write-up: patterns, what broke, what LiveKit could make easier.
- The hackathon kit itself, released as the reference template for community-run LiveKit hackathons anywhere.

Talks

- Two conference submissions (AI Engineer Code Summit, ScaLE 24x) with the deck and demo repo published on acceptance, and re-used as meetup material either way.

The feedback loop

How community signal reaches Product, on a schedule, with numbers

The posting asks for someone who brings back trends, patterns and narratives. Anecdotes from a hallway do not survive a roadmap meeting; counted, quoted, reproducible signal does. Every event and every channel feeds one intake, and one document goes out every week.

Intake

- A two-question card at every event (what did you try to build, where did you get stuck) collected at the door and on the way out.
- `workshop_status` and `participant_list` during workshops and the hackathon: which rooms went quiet, which teams never published media, when they dropped. Drop-off is data, not a feeling.
- Community channel triage tagged by product area and failure mode: Slack, Discord, GitHub issues and the forum, twice a week.
- Ten developer interviews in month 1, five per month after that.

Output

- **Weekly field notes** to Product, DevRel and PMM: top five friction points with quotes and counts, what changed since last week, what is still open.
- **GitHub issues with reproduction steps** for anything a developer hit twice. Target ten or more filed by day 90.
- **Monthly community signal review** (30 minutes, Product and Engineering): trends, requested integrations, competitor mentions, narratives developers use unprompted.
- **Day-90 community report**: every number on the targets page, what the events taught us, and the Q1 plan.

How I would work

Weeks 1 to 2: Listen before hosting: attend, interview, audit the channels, and ship the first CFP. Agree the event budget, venue partners and the Marketing amplification checklist.

Weekly: One event action (host, prep, or venue), one content artifact shipped, one field-notes document sent, one number reported.

Per event: Recap, demo video and tutorial within 72 hours. Intake cards counted the same night. Attendance and activation logged in the shared tracker.

Always: Every demo runs against a real LiveKit server before it is shown. Every hackathon room is provisioned by the kit, not by hand. Nothing is presented that cannot be cloned.

Targets I would report at day 90

Numbers, not adjectives. Each target has a counting method agreed in week 1 so the day-90 report is a table, not a narrative.

METRIC	HOW IT IS COUNTED	DAY-90 TARGET
Meetup attendance	Checked-in attendees per meetup, from the registration tool; growth month over month	60 / 75 / 90
Workshop completions	Seats that reached a working voice agent in the hour (participant publishing audio)	24 of 30
Hackathon builders and teams	Checked-in builders; teams that joined their room at least once (workshop_status)	100 / 25
Repos created at the hackathon	Public repos submitted at judging that call LiveKit	25
Teams with a working demo	Teams whose demo ran over a real call at judging	18 of 25 (70%)
Activation	Attendees who create a LiveKit Cloud project within 14 days of an event (UTM on join sheet and recap links)	30%
Content shipped	Recaps, demo videos, tutorials published within 72 hours of the event they came from	5 / 6 / 4
Feedback delivered	Weekly field-notes documents; GitHub issues with repro; monthly signal reviews	12 / 10+ / 3
New community members	Net new members in LiveKit's community channel attributed to events (join source)	300

Assumptions, confirmed or corrected in week 1: start Monday, October 5, 2026; one Marketing partner for amplification and registration; a venue budget for five events; a LiveKit Cloud credit pool for prizes and workshop seats.

Why these numbers are reachable

Rooms, tokens, join sheet, status board and teardown are one MCP call each and already pass against a live server, so the hackathon and workshop hours are spent building. The meetups draw from the Summit crowd in November and the hackathon in December; each event feeds the next.